

GRANT NEILSON

Computational Biologist with seven years of industry experience building scalable and robust analysis pipelines, developing internal Python & R packages and processing large-scale whole genome and single cell sequencing datasets (1TB+). Committed to writing production-quality code through rigorous testing, version control, and thorough documentation. Active open-source contributor, passionate about developing reliable scientific software and advancing reproducible research through community-driven collaboration.

View this CV [online](#)

CONTACT

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🐙 [GitHub](#)

in [LinkedIn](#)

INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

2026
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2023

Senior Computational Biologist

[CoSyne Therapeutics](#)

📍 London, UK

- Led analysis of large-scale genomic datasets to support biomarker discovery and target id, translating complex results into clear, decision-ready outputs for cross-functional teams. Culminated in the successful partnership with a publicly traded biotech.
- Co-Developed and maintained internal & open source R and Python packages. For statistical modeling, data processing and visualisation. Bixverse, is a Rust based R package enabling the analysis of 3 million single cells on a standard laptop. Cosyne-cnutils is a python package used for the analysis of genomics data
- Developed internal container system using Docker and ECR, to enable reproducible research. This system used CI/CD to build images robustly and securely.
- Recognized as a named contributor in version 3.4.1 of the NF-core Sarek pipeline. Optimised the running of the pipeline, achieving a 50% cost reduction and 30% decrease in computational time per sample.

2023
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2020

Computational Biologist

[Fios Genomics](#)

📍 Edinburgh, UK

- Directed projects focusing on high-dimensional omics data types (WES, WGS, scRNA-seq, proteomics), delivering comprehensive analyses and reports for clients.
- Developed in-depth knowledge of statistical methodologies, mastering model selection and fitting techniques, including SVM, elastic net, random forest, and linear/logistic regression, while accounting for covariates.
- Actively contributed to internal R&D by developing and maintaining specialized R packages, enhancing the team's analytical capabilities.
- Led client calls, effectively communicating complex analytical results, ensuring clarity and client understanding.

2020
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2019

Computational Biologist

[Complex Diseases Epigenetics group, Exeter Medical School](#)

📍 Exeter, UK

- Developed novel bioinformatics pipelines for processing genomics data.
- Gained an understanding of regression analysis, how to account for covariates, feature selection and optimal model fitting.

LANGUAGES

📊 R

🐍 Python

</> Bash

🔧 Nextflow

TECHNOLOGIES

🐙 GitLab/GitHub

🐳 Docker

aws aws

🖥️ Azure

OPEN SOURCE & PUBLIC PROJECTS

📊 [bixverse](#)

📊 [mainfoldsR](#)

📊 [cosyne-cnutils](#)

🔧 [Sarek](#)

Made with the R package [pagedown](#).

The source code is available on [GitHub](#).

Last updated February 2026.



EDUCATION

2019
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2015

MSCi Biology

University of Southampton

📍 Southampton, UK

- Grade : First Class Honors
- Winner of the British Society for Immunology Graduate of the year award.
- Recipient of the summer studentship from the Genetics Society (2017).

2015
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2013

School

Merchiston Castle Shool

📍 Edinburgh, UK

- A Levels: Biology, Chemistry, Maths



SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

2025

Multi modal single cell foundation models via dynamic token adaptation

BioRxiv

- Wenmin Zhao, AnaSolaguren-Beascoa, Grant Neilson, Regina Reynolds, Louwai Muhammed, Liisi Laaniste, Sera Aylin Cakiroglu
- Role: Data Preprocessing
- doi: <https://doi.org/10.1101/2025.04.17.649387>

2025

Detecting cell level transcriptomic changes of Perturb seq using Contrastive Fine tuning of Single Cell Foundation Models

BioRxiv

- Wenmin Zhao, AnaSolaguren-Beascoa, Grant Neilson, Regina Reynolds, Louwai Muhammed, Liisi Laaniste, Sera Aylin Cakiroglu
- Role: Data Preprocessing
- doi: <https://doi.org/10.1101/2025.04.17.649395>